

Narayan Ashanahalli

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Hi, I'm a product designer and prototyper. I design and build end-to-end, from research, interaction models, and visual craft to **shipped tools, prototypes, and full-stack platforms**. Looking to join a lean, technical team building thoughtful products with care, craft, and strong product judgment.

WORK EXPERIENCE

UX Designer & Researcher

December 2024 – Present

Lab 4 Cybernetics | Pittsburgh, PA

- Led the design and full-stack development of the Lab for Cybernetics' digital platform, replacing fragmented Google Docs and Notion workflows with a modular **Notion-based CMS**, increasing **user participation by 80%**.
- Shipped an **OTP-secured AI matchmaking feature** for **25+ practitioners and scholars**, using profile submissions, research interests, expertise, AI-generated **topic chips**, and **match reasoning** to recommend relevant collaborators.
- Implemented the platform with Next.js/TypeScript frontend, Notion API, and Gmail SMTP, with **modular CMS** workflows and **dev-documentation** for future maintainers and non-technical content updates.

Project Designer

August 2023 – July 2024

Studio Chintala | Bangalore, India

- Led research, concept development, and delivery of Working, Living & Innovating, translating **behavioral field user research** across an industrial campus into a phased design strategy that secured **\$10,000 Phase I approval**.
- Developed a **systems-based intervention framework** across 5 spatial domains, presenting **cost-tiered prototypes** to stakeholders and driving alignment between **worker experience goals** and **operational constraints**.

Machine Learning Intern

August 2020 – December 2020

Uniworks Design | Hyderabad, India

- Constructed training dataset for **ArP-Gen GAN model**: validated 2,000+ architectural floor plans with feature labels.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

HCI Researcher | [Pointobot](#)

August 2025 – Present

Master's Thesis

- Built a **2-DOF laser mechanism** (lab assistant) with voice input and **LLM-based** spatial reasoning — physically pointing to real-world locations in a shared lab environment as a primary communication channel.
- Investigated **pointing** and **dectics** as an interaction paradigm for **HAI** — designing for a world where AI references physical space directly rather than describing it through language.
- Developed a **responsive gesture library** for communicating **robot state** through physical movement, removing the need for screen or voice output for a **lab prototype** currently used by **15+ students daily**.

Product Designer | [Dot Threads](#)

November 2025 – January 2026

Browser Extension for Knowledge Management

- Designed and shipped **Dot Threads**, a **Chrome extension** that turns **saved links** into a **spatial graph**, helping users **organize, edit and share** research by **context** and **relationships**, alternative to the traditional bookmarking.
- Validated the workflow through **25 user** interviews across 3 CMU departments and shipped a **4-click save flow** with **right-click capture, contextual tagging, and graph-based retrieval**, live on the Web Store with **10+ active users**.

Interaction Designer | [Piko](#)

March 2025 – May 2025

Context-Aware Wearable Assistant

- Designed a **soft robotic companion** detecting doom-scrolling posture with **91% accuracy** using a custom-trained computer vision model, delivering peripheral physical feedback as a **habit-building nudge**.
- Developed an **emotive gesture library** translating **4 behavioral states** into physical servo movements — **curiosity, joy, shyness, anger** — creating **social feedback** without language.
- Trained a custom **CV model on 600+ images** using Roboflow, to **detect doom-scrolling** posture and trigger **real-time physical feedback** through across a **3-node Raspberry Pi architecture** for **low-latency**, accurate **real-time** response.

EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University

Master of Advanced Architectural Design

Pittsburgh, PA

May 2026

JNAFA University

Bachelor of Architecture

Hyderabad, IN

July 2023

SKILLS

Design: Interaction Design, Information Architecture, Visual Design, Rapid Prototyping, Design Systems, Workflow Design, User Testing, Systems Thinking, Micro-interaction Design, Human-AI Interaction, Conversation Design

Tools: Figma, FigJam, Framer, Miro, Illustrator, Photoshop, After Effects, Indesign, Adobe XD, Notion, ProtoPie, Voiceflow, Procreate, Google Analytics, Heap, Hotjar, Userlytics, GitHub, Rhino 3D, Blender

Technical: HTML, CSS, React, TypeScript, Python, API Integration, Version Control (Git), SQL, MCP, AI-assisted coding with Cursor, Claude Code